

# I Tried 500+ AI Tools, These 7 Will Make You Rich

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GFLu5kBXjys> Source: full transcript

## Executive Summary

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Brandon Carter, founder of multiple 7- and 8-figure businesses who once employed 40 staff, reveals the 7 AI tools now running his entire operation — covering video editing, CRM, agentic research, competitor intelligence, content creation, and business automation.

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## Background & Context 0:00

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- Brandon Carter runs several multi-7-figure businesses and one 8-figure business
  - Has helped 15,000+ people grow online fitness businesses
  - Many students earn hundreds of thousands/year; some earn millions
- Previously employed **~40 people** on staff
  - Has not fired anyone, but uses AI to avoid rehiring when people leave naturally
  - AI has multiplied both his productivity and income
- Claims to have tested **over 500 AI tools** before settling on this list

## Tool 1: ChatGPT Codex (Astra 6.1) 1:11

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- Codex is described as the "advanced version" of ChatGPT — specifically the **Astra 6.1 model**
  - Not the standard ChatGPT phone app; a separate, more powerful environment
  - Brandon calls it his "headquarters" — runs virtually his entire business from it

## Video Editing Use Case

- Edits both short-form (Instagram Reels, TikToks) and long-form YouTube videos inside Codex
  - Claims a typical video edit takes ~**20 minutes**
  - Uses a project called "YouTube video editing" with saved "skills" (custom instruction sets)
- Required supporting tools to enable video editing in Codex:
  - **video-use** — free GitHub repo; handles core video editing tasks
  - **HyperFrames** — free GitHub repo; another editing layer
  - **ElevenLabs** (paid) — transcribes videos so Codex knows when/where things are said, enabling auto-cut of mistakes, restarts, and caption mapping

## Skills System

- Brandon has built multiple reusable "skills" inside Codex projects:
  - **Talking Head 1** — no B-roll images; caption-only style
  - **Talking Head 2** — finds images online and overlays them with captions
  - **Reference Reuse** — downloads a reel from Instagram, says "edit mine just like this," and Codex replicates the format with his own B-roll
  - **Three Stack Skill** — searches a dedicated B-roll folder, proposes shots, Brandon approves, then posts
  - **IG Carousel Skill** — drops in a YouTube video, Codex extracts the best points and generates a slide deck using real photos of Brandon (no AI-generated images to avoid Instagram's AI-content labels)
- Codex iterates interactively — Brandon reviews outputs, says "change that," and it revises
- After approval, **posts directly to Instagram, Facebook, YouTube Shorts, and TikTok** via GoHighLevel integration

## Sales Call Review

- Team downloads sales calls → Codex reviews them immediately
  - Sends feedback to the sales rep on what they did well / could improve
  - Sends Brandon a copy tracking who is performing
  - Logs customer language (hopes, dreams, aspirations) into a copywriting skill to use in actual ad copy

## Espionage OS (Competitor Intelligence Dashboard)

- Built a custom dashboard called "Espionage OS" inside Codex
  - Aggregates all ads competitors are running
  - Ranked by **ad run duration** — longer-running ads are treated as more profitable/proven
  - Shows ad creative, copy text, and full video transcript for each competitor ad
  - Also tracks competitors' organic posts
- Philosophy: *"Sun Tzu in The Art of War said you need to know your enemy better than they know themselves"*

## Full List of Codex Use Cases

- Long-form YouTube video editing
- Short-form Reel/TikTok editing
- Video slide decks / PowerPoints
- Instagram carousels
- Custom dashboards (e.g., Espionage OS)
- Data analytics
- Website building
- Internal custom tools
- Managing VAs (Codex communicates with virtual assistants)
- Running YouTube, Instagram, and Facebook ads (integrated with Ads Manager)
- Webinar content

**Codex is Brandon's single most-used tool — his entire business operation runs through it.**



## Tool 2: GoHighLevel 9:30

- CRM Brandon has used for **almost 10 years**
- Core functions:
  - Manage customers and leads
  - Build lead magnets and digital assets
  - Run full sales operations
  - Post to all social media platforms
  - View all DMs from social media in one place
  - Track text message and email responses
  - Book calendar meetings
  - Host most websites and landing pages
  - "Comment this word and I'll DM you" automations on Instagram

## Integration with Codex

- GoHighLevel is integrated directly into Codex
  - When Brandon says "post this to Instagram" in Codex, GoHighLevel executes it
  - Can manage GoHighLevel entirely through Codex without logging in manually

## AI Studio — Interactive Lead Magnet Example: "The Ripped Roadmap"

- GoHighLevel has an **AI Studio** (similar to Lovable) for building AI-powered web tools
- Brandon built an interactive lead magnet called **The Ripped Roadmap**:
  - User inputs: height, weight, age, photo, goals

- AI analyzes the photo → estimates body fat % and pounds of fat mass
- Gives a personalized game plan including macros
- Brandon's demo result: estimated **7% body fat**, recommended gaining **11 lbs of muscle**
- Ends with a VSL and a call-booking CTA
- Built entirely through **prompting** (used ChatGPT to help write the prompt first)
- Key advantage over external tools like Lovable: **automatically links to the CRM with one click**, no manual integration needed → flows into all workflows and automations

## Free Trial Offer

- **30-day free trial** available via link in description
- Signing up also unlocks:
  - All of Brandon's Codex skills (video editing, carousels, etc.)
  - GoHighLevel templates including the Ripped Roadmap
  - Email sequences, text sequences, automations, and GoHighLevel agents

## Free Live Training Promo [13:35](#)

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- Brandon is running a **free live training** on making an extra **\$300–\$500/day** as an online trainer using AI
  - Topics: content ideation, scripting, filming with AI
  - Live Q&A before, during, and after
  - Free AI tools given away during the session
  - Register via link in description even if you can't attend live (to be notified of next session)

## Tool 3: Grok Bot [14:21](#)

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- Primary use: **agentic research and automation** — has its own computer and credentials
  - Uses a service called **Agent Mail** to give bots their own email addresses and logins
  - Logs into external sites, retrieves customer data, finds content ideas
  - Filters daily news and sends curated summaries

## Active Bots Brandon Runs in Grok Bot

- **Chief of Staff bot** — general oversight
- **Project Manager bot** — task management
- **Sales Call Reviewer** — reviews transcripts from the note-taker all sales reps use; grades calls; pushes feedback to team via Slack integration ("Give Brian or Miguel some feedback")
- **Stock Trading bot** — connected to **Robinhood API**, executing trades automatically ("still a work in progress")
- **Polymarket Trading bot** — betting on prediction markets automatically (also work in progress)
- **Subscription Auditor** — reviews all subscriptions and flags ones to cancel
- **Meeting Transcription + Task Assignment bot:**

- Transcribes every meeting
- Identifies action items Brandon committed to
- Estimates time required for each task
- Adds tasks to **Notion** (project management software)
- Blocks calendar time in white space for each task
- Assigns tasks to meeting participants in the project manager
- Sends reminders when tasks are overdue or approaching
- **GoHighLevel bot** — handles GoHighLevel tasks so Brandon rarely needs to log in manually
- **Slack bot** — keeps the entire remote team updated

## Pricing Context

- Brandon is on the **\$100/month Grok plan** and the **\$60/month Cursor plan**
  - Was still running out of credits before Meta Muse arrived
  - Now uses Muse to stay within Grok usage limits

## Tool 4: Meta Muse 16:36

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- Owned by Meta → **deep native integration** with Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, Threads, and Meta Ads Manager
  - No third-party connectors needed for Meta platforms
- Started as a daily accountability tool; now used for full business operations
- Brandon pays **\$60/month** and has never come close to running out of credits (generous free tier also available)
- Interface: one main agent ("Muse") with different chats instead of separate bots
  - Brandon customized his Muse as an "African-American robot named Tyrone"

## Competitor Research Example (for community member Corey Armstrong)

- Corey Armstrong — fitness coach targeting men over 30 for fat loss, 300K followers
- Brandon's workflow inside Muse:
  - Step 1 — "Find Corey's top 5 competitors on Instagram"
  - Step 2 — "Search their profiles over the last 90 days. Give me their top performing Reels — topics, hooks, formats. Comprehensive breakdown."
  - Step 3 — Muse generates a full artifact (structured report) covering each competitor's best content
  - Step 4 — "DM this to Corey" → Muse sends it directly via Instagram DM
  - Step 5 — "Make Corey a 30-day content strategy based on what you found" → delivers a branded strategy using **Corey's actual brand colors** (pulled from his Instagram profile)

## Lead Magnet Creation Example (for community member Kelly Nicole Fit)

- Kelly is a fitness creator getting married; Muse analyzed her Instagram page

- Brandon's workflow:
  - Step 1 — "Analyze Kelly's content and give me 20 lead magnet ideas"
  - Step 2 — Selected **"Wedding Shred Checklist"** (relevant to her current life situation)
  - Step 3 — "Write this guide in Kelly's voice using ONLY things she's actually said on Instagram — don't fill in the blanks"
  - Step 4 — Muse pulled her actual quotes from Instagram and wrote the guide
  - Step 5 — "Make the CTA link at the end the same link that's in her bio" → clickable link to her VSL/booking page
- Note: Brandon recommended Kelly swap out AI-generated images for real photos — a quick manual edit

Meta Muse's native Instagram integration means no third-party tools needed — what would require external APIs elsewhere is built in.

## **Tool 5: Claude Code 20:49**

- Used primarily for: content research, auditing creator accounts, studying winning content, scripting, writing
  - Brandon's opinion: **"Claude's writing is just better"** — something about the model produces superior output for writing tasks
- Personal use cases:
  - Tracking macros daily (long-running habit)
  - Developing offers and sales assets
  - Building apps and automations
  - Goal tracking and brand building
- Pricing: **\$200/month** for Claude Code
  - When Brandon burns through his Codex (\$500/month credits) by using "Ultra Fast" mode, he shifts to Claude Code
- Has also edited videos in Claude Code — says it works well, but prefers the Codex interface
  - Mentions new "dots" feature in Codex as a significant upgrade (dedicated video coming soon)
- Key distinction: everything doable in Codex is also doable in Claude Code; Brandon uses both primarily due to muscle memory and credit management

## **Tool 6: Google Gemini 22:22**

- Brandon uses it less than before but keeps it for one killer use case: **niche hacking via video analysis**

### **Niche Hacking Strategy (Fastest Way to Grow on Instagram)**

- **Concept:** Find "outlier content" — videos getting **10x views relative to the creator's follower count**
  - Example: A creator with 133K followers getting **11 million views** on a Reel

- Signals they found a uniquely effective format, hook, or topic
- **Analogy:** Like songs sharing the same key and chord progression — same skeleton, different lyrics/melody/tempo. Not copying; just using the same structural framework.
- **Tool for finding outliers: Sorter for TikTok and Instagram** — free Chrome extension; sorts content by view count to surface outliers quickly

## Gemini's Unique Advantage for This

- You can **drop an MP4 file directly into Gemini** — no third-party transcription tool needed
- Prompt structure Brandon uses:
  - "This video went viral. Break down why it went viral, transcribe it, then interview me with questions until you have enough context to write MY own version — but do NOT copy."
  - Gemini explains why the video worked (great for beginners learning content strategy)
  - Then asks Brandon questions iteratively
  - Outputs a custom script he can film that captures the format without copying the words
- Emphasizes: copying words = wrong; using the same format = totally fine (formats are not copyrightable)

## Other Gemini Uses

- Generating B-roll footage when needed
- **Music creation** — comparable to Suno but cheaper; can produce full songs/beats
- Quick factual lookups — Brandon keeps it open as a fast, low-friction search alternative

## Tool 7: Connectors 25:45

- The "glue" that makes all the other tools work together as a unified system
- Key connectors Brandon uses:

| Connector                | What It Enables                                                                                                |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Apple Health</b>      | Syncs Oura Ring data; Claude calculates daily calorie burn vs. macro intake to show deficit/surplus            |
| <b>Notion</b>            | Project management + database; receives auto-uploaded health/macro logs and task assignments from meeting bots |
| <b>ElevenLabs</b>        | Video transcription for Codex to enable precise editing and caption placement                                  |
| <b>GoHighLevel (CRM)</b> | Connected to Grok Bot, Claude, and ChatGPT; enables posting and lead management from any platform              |

- Philosophy: none of the 7 tools reaches its full potential in isolation — the integrations between them are what create the "rich" outcome
- Brandon mentions dedicated deeper-dive videos on both Meta Muse and Codex for those wanting more detail